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ENGLISH LANGUAGE STANDARD SEVEN

Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE) 2021 Answer Key and Worked Solutions

Subject	English Language
Code	02
Level	Standard Seven
Year	2021
Exam Board	NECTA
Exam	Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE)
Type	Answer key and worked solutions
Questions	45 questions

Try each question before checking the solution. Follow the steps, compare your working, and practise the parts you find difficult.

Source paper: English-S7-2021.pdf

Section A — Listening

1. What does Sheila do when she has a problem?

Step 1: The passage distinguishes seeking help from asking to go out.

Step 2: She approaches her teachers for assistance with a problem.

Final Answer: D — She asks her teachers for help.

2. What makes Sheila a good example?

Step 1: Notice the polite behaviour described across different situations.

Step 2: She treats other people respectfully.

Final Answer: A — She respects everyone.

3. Whom should children respect according to the story?

Step 1: The example includes teachers, pupils, family and neighbours.

Step 2: The lesson therefore extends to everybody, not just one group.

Final Answer: C — All people.

4. Which class was Sheila in?

Step 1: Find the class stated when Sheila is introduced.

Step 2: The passage identifies her as a class-six pupil.

Final Answer: D — Class Six.

5. What should a child do after receiving help?

Step 1: Sheila responds politely after permission or assistance.

Step 2: The suitable response is to express gratitude.

Final Answer: D — Be thankful.

Section Summary: Distinguish what a person does in a problem from how they respond after receiving help.

Section A — Grammar and vocabulary

6. The sun ___ in the morning.

Step 1: This is a habitual fact in the present simple.

Step 2: The singular subject sun takes the verb rises.

Final Answer: B — rises.

7. They ___ waiting when it began to rain.

Step 1: An ongoing past action uses was/were + -ing.

Step 2: They is plural, so use were.

Final Answer: C — were.

8. Rose has a graduation ceremony. Are you ___?

Step 1: The person receives an invitation rather than performing the inviting.

Step 2: Use the passive participle invited after are.

Final Answer: E — invited.

9. During the slave trade, human beings ___ like animals.

Step 1: Human beings receive the action, so use the passive.

Step 2: The plural subject and past setting require were sold.

Final Answer: D — were sold.

10. Every child ___ given cake after the song.

Step 1: Every child is grammatically singular.

Step 2: The past passive is was given.

Final Answer: C — was.

11. Open the book ___ page 3.

Step 1: The intended fixed phrase locates the opening at a page.

Step 2: Use at.

Final Answer: C — at.

12. Is there ___ water left in the jug?

Step 1: Water is uncountable and this is a neutral question about existence.

Step 2: Any is the intended quantifier in a general question.

Final Answer: A — any.

13. The car belongs to James. It is ___ car.

Step 1: A possessive form is needed before car.

Step 2: NECTA's marking choice uses an apostrophe after the final s: James'.

Final Answer: C — James'.

Study Tip: E — James's is also accepted in standard English. Cambridge Grammar allows either form for personal names ending in s; C is the expected exam choice.

14. I sit ___ Anna and Jane.

Step 1: The position is in the space separating two named people.

Step 2: Between expresses that relationship.

Final Answer: B — between.

15. One of ___ wore broken sunglasses.

Step 1: The pronoun refers to the seven men.

Step 2: After of, use the object form them.

Final Answer: C — them.

16. No sooner had she arrived ___ it began to rain.

Step 1: The paired construction is no sooner ... than.

Step 2: Than introduces the immediately following event.

Final Answer: A — than.

17. The girl won ___ she had trained well.

Step 1: Training is the cause of her success.

Step 2: Because introduces that reason.

Final Answer: E — because.

18. Put Musa is running to school into the past continuous.

Step 1: Change the present auxiliary is to the past was.

Step 2: Keep the -ing form running.

Final Answer: D — Musa was running to school.

19. The thief entered ___ the open window.

Step 1: The route passes from one side of an opening to the other.

Step 2: Through describes movement across that opening.

Final Answer: B — through.

20. Report: They said, We work together.

Step 1: Change the quoted we to they.

Step 2: With the past reporting verb said, work normally backshifts to worked.

Final Answer: D — They said that they worked together.

21. Where is a designated place to cross a road?

Step 1: The question asks for a crossing specifically marked for pedestrians.

Step 2: A zebra crossing is that marked point.

Final Answer: C — At the zebra crossing.

22. Which prefix has a negative meaning?

Step 1: Un- can mean not, as in unhappy or unfair.

Step 2: The other listed prefixes concern repetition or time.

Final Answer: C — un-.

23. Our grandparents were disciplined in their ____.

Step 1: The blank needs the name of the period when they were children.

Step 2: Childhood names that stage of life.

Final Answer: D — childhood.

24. Ngole crossed despite a Do not cross poster because he ____ it.

Step 1: The context indicates incorrect understanding.

Step 2: Mis- + understood forms misunderstood.

Final Answer: A — misunderstood.

25. Our well-decorated house is ____.

Step 1: After is, use an adjective describing the house.

Step 2: Beautiful is the adjective; beautifully is an adverb.

Final Answer: C — beautiful.

26. What is a person walking along a road called?

Step 1: The question seeks the road-user category for someone on foot.

Step 2: That person is a pedestrian.

Final Answer: A — Pedestrian.

27. Julius performs medical operations. What profession is offered in the options?

Step 1: Operations are performed by trained medical practitioners.

Step 2: Doctor is the relevant option; surgeon is the more specific term for the specialist.

Final Answer: A — Doctor.

28. Give a phrase with the same meaning as continue.

Step 1: Continue means proceed with an activity.

Step 2: Carry on is the matching phrasal verb.

Final Answer: A — carry on.

29. Aisha is the oldest of three children. Complete: Aisha is ____.

Step 1: Comparing three family members requires a superlative.

Step 2: The eldest is the suitable family-age expression in the choices.

Final Answer: B — the eldest.

30. Give the opposite of old in old English.

Step 1: The context compares earlier and later language forms.

Step 2: Modern contrasts with old.

Final Answer: B — modern.

31. What word class is quietly in The old man shut the door quietly?

Step 1: Quietly tells how the door was shut.

Step 2: A word modifying the manner of an action is an adverb.

Final Answer: C — An adverb.

32. A puppy unable to care for itself was left ____.

Step 1: The suffix -less expresses absence of something.

Step 2: Helpless means unable to help or protect itself.

Final Answer: E — helpless.

33. The sun rises in the east and sets in the ____.

Step 1: Recall the two opposite cardinal directions in the usual statement.

Step 2: The sunset direction is west.

Final Answer: A — West.

34. What is my sister's son to me?

Step 1: A sibling's male child is called a nephew.

Step 2: A female child would be a niece.

Final Answer: C — Nephew.

35. Find a homophone of made.

Step 1: A homophone sounds the same but differs in spelling and meaning.

Step 2: Made and maid have the same pronunciation.

Final Answer: E — maid.

Section Summary: Identify sentence function before choosing a word. Keep tense, subject agreement and pronoun case consistent.

Section B — Composition

36. Order: In his speech, he promised to buy the pupils' products.

Step 1: The teacher must first be invited and speak.

Step 2: His promise comes after the speech is introduced and before the pupils thank him.

Final Answer: D — Fourth sentence.

37. Order: Standard Seven pupils had a cooking project.

Step 1: Introduce the participants and event first.

Step 2: This supplies the opening of the composition.

Final Answer: A — First sentence.

38. Order: The head teacher talked to the pupils.

Step 1: The invitation to view the project precedes the talk.

Step 2: The content of his speech follows, so this is third.

Final Answer: C — Third sentence.

39. Order: The pupils thanked him and invited him again.

Step 1: Thanks respond to the teacher's visit and promise.

Step 2: This closes the account.

Final Answer: E — Fifth sentence.

40. Order: They invited the head teacher to see the project.

Step 1: They refers back to the pupils introduced in the opening.

Step 2: The invitation comes before the teacher speaks.

Final Answer: B — Second sentence.

Section Summary: The complete order is 37 → 40 → 38 → 36 → 39: project, invitation, talk, promise and thanks.

Section C — Poetry comprehension

41. What is the poem about?

Step 1: The final stanza names Covid-19.

Step 2: The remaining stanzas describe the disease and its effects.

Final Answer: Covid-19 and its effects on people.

42. Who speaks in the poem?

Step 1: The speaker addresses my clansmen and later says us.

Step 2: These pronouns show membership in the affected community.

Final Answer: A member of the community affected by Covid-19.

43. According to the poem, how does the virus spread?

Step 1: Locate the opening line of the third stanza.

Step 2: Answer the route stated by the poem rather than add information from outside it.

Final Answer: According to the poem, it spreads through contact.

44. What measures does the poem suggest to prevent spread?

Step 1: The third stanza mentions a protective measure.

Step 2: The last stanza also stresses the value of information.

Final Answer: Wearing face masks and providing information about the disease.

45. What impacts are mentioned?

Step 1: Identify consequences in the opening and final stanzas.

Step 2: The poem mentions deaths, fear of working and interruption of schooling.

Final Answer: Many people die, people fear going to work, and children stop attending school.

Section Summary: Use the poem's wording and pronouns as evidence. The speaking voice is a member of the affected community, not automatically the author.

Source Checks

NECTA: PSLE 2021 English analysis

Cambridge Grammar: possessive names ending in s